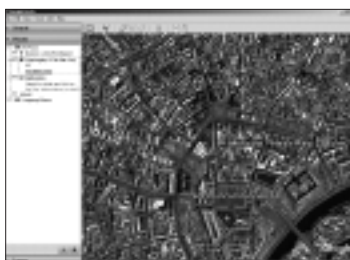


You can also share the placemark by using a KML file. The KML file, or the Keyhole Markup Language file, is a file that contains information regarding geographic features such as points, lines, images, polygons, and models that can be displayed in Google Earth and Google Maps. To save space, the KML information is saved as a KMZ file—a compressed KML file. KMZ files can also be opened directly in Google Earth and Google Maps. Right-click on the placemark and select **Save As**. Choose a filename and click **Save**. The resulting KMZ file can now be distributed to other users of Google Earth, and also submitted to the Google Earth community site.



New Placemark



Share your Placemark

8.4 Layers

Layers are additional “layers”—literally—of geographic points laid over the basic map data. Layers are grouped into categories and sub-categories, and can be turned on or off from the Layers panel. Each layer can have hundreds and thousands of placemarks. In fact, the placemarks stored in the My Places folder are also layers in a certain sense. Like layers, placemarks can also be turned on or off by enabling or clearing the checkboxes.

There are many categories of layers, ranging from Terrain to Roads to State and Country borders, among others. Each layer adds specific geographic information related to the layer category. For

example, National Geographic has a whole section of layers related to their articles and stories. By turning on the National Geographic layer, you can see all the geographic locations linked to their stories. Clicking on a National Geographic placemark will show you summary details of the particular story, links to images and the text of the article, and perhaps even videos.

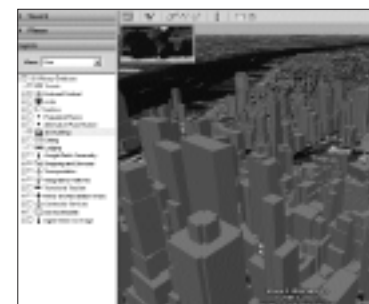
These layers are also referred to as Points Of Interest, and can be saved like regular placemarks to your My Places folder in the Places panel. Points of Interests can also include commercial and business information. Similarly, you can turn on the Google Earth Community layer to view placemarks created by the community, as well as your own placemarks submitted to the bulletin board.



Placemark from National Geographic's Feature Article & Photo Layer

You can use the View field to control the list of layer categories that is displayed in the Layer panel. Core displays only key layers, All Layers displays all, and Now Enabled displays all currently enabled layers.

3D models of buildings can be viewed by turning on the 3D Buildings layer, and zooming in over a city like New York. The aerial view will now show an overlay of grey boxes. Use the navigation controls to zoom in closer, rotate, tilt, and navigate around the buildings!



View cities in their 3D glory